

Task 'Introduction to Cloud Fundamentals and Services' Unit 1

Formative Discussion: AWS vs Azure Cloud

Amazon Web Services (AWS) and Microsoft Azure are the two of the leading cloud computing providers, both offer Infrastructure as a Service (IaaS), Platform as a Service (PaaS), and Software as a Service (SaaS) and more. Although both platforms provide scalable and secure cloud environments, they differ in some areas such as flexibility, pricing approaches, and the types of organizations they best support.

AWS is recognized for its wide portfolio of cloud services and increased level of flexibility. AWS offers a more extensive range of configurable services, which is suitable for organizations that require a more customizable architectures with wide-scale application, development and advanced cloud-native deployments, AWS also provides mature capabilities for workload management with improved cost optimization, supporting companies that wish to tailor resources closer to operational requirements.

(Amazon Web Services, 2024a).

The Microsoft Azure solutions, are usually preferred by organizations that are already operating with Microsoft technologies at their core business, such as Windows Server, Active Directory, and Microsoft 365. Azure's seamless integration with these enterprise products simplifies hybrid cloud deployment and management, making it an attractive choice for businesses to modernize existing IT infrastructure. Microsoft also emphasizes architectural best practices through its Azure Well-Architected Framework, supporting reliability, security, and cost optimization.

(Microsoft, 2026).

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Pricing differs primarily in complexity rather than overall cost. While Both providers offer a pay-as-you-go operation model with some benefits for capacity savings and long-term commitments. Nevertheless, the actual costs depend heavily on workload design, resource selection, and governance. Effective cloud governance and service selection hold a significant influence on total cost than the choice of provider itself.

AWS is may generally be considered a better suited for institutions that prioritize innovation, flexibility and cloud-native development, whereas Azure delivers more advantages for institutions with Microsoft based ecosystems and hybrid cloud strategies. Therefore, the most appropriate provider depends on business objectives, requirements, existing architecture, and governance capabilities rather than feature verity alone.

(Shamkura, 2025; Amazon Web Services, 2024b).

References

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